

Section C: Mini Project

1. Tool Justification: Why did you choose your specific selection tool over the standard Lasso tool for this product?
 - For this product image, I chose the **Object Selection Tool** instead of the standard **Lasso Tool** because it uses AI-powered object detection to automatically identify and select the serum bottle with high accuracy. The bottle has clear edges and a distinct shape, making it ideal for Object Selection. This tool significantly reduces selection time and produces cleaner results than manually tracing the object with the Lasso Tool. The Lasso Tool requires hand-drawn selections, which can be less precise and more time-consuming, especially around curved and detailed edges. Therefore, the Object Selection Tool provides greater efficiency, accuracy, and a more professional result.
2. Workflow Logic: How does using a Layer Mask instead of the Eraser tool preserve image quality and allow for future edits?
 - A **Layer Mask** is a non-destructive editing technique that hides unwanted portions of an image without permanently deleting any pixels. If adjustments are needed later, hidden areas can easily be restored by modifying the mask. In contrast, the **Eraser Tool** permanently removes pixel data, making future corrections difficult or impossible. By using a Layer Mask, the original image remains intact, preserving image quality and providing flexibility for revisions. This approach is considered a professional workflow because it allows continuous refinement without damaging the source image.
3. Realism Outcome: How does the addition of a custom shadow influence the customer's perception of the product's quality?
 - Adding a **custom contact shadow** beneath the product helps it appear naturally placed within the scene rather than floating above the background. The shadow creates depth, dimension, and a realistic connection between the product and the surface. A well-designed shadow makes the product look professionally photographed and visually appealing, which can positively influence a customer's perception of quality and trustworthiness. Products presented with realistic lighting and shadows

often appear more premium, polished, and credible, increasing their attractiveness in advertisements and e-commerce listings.